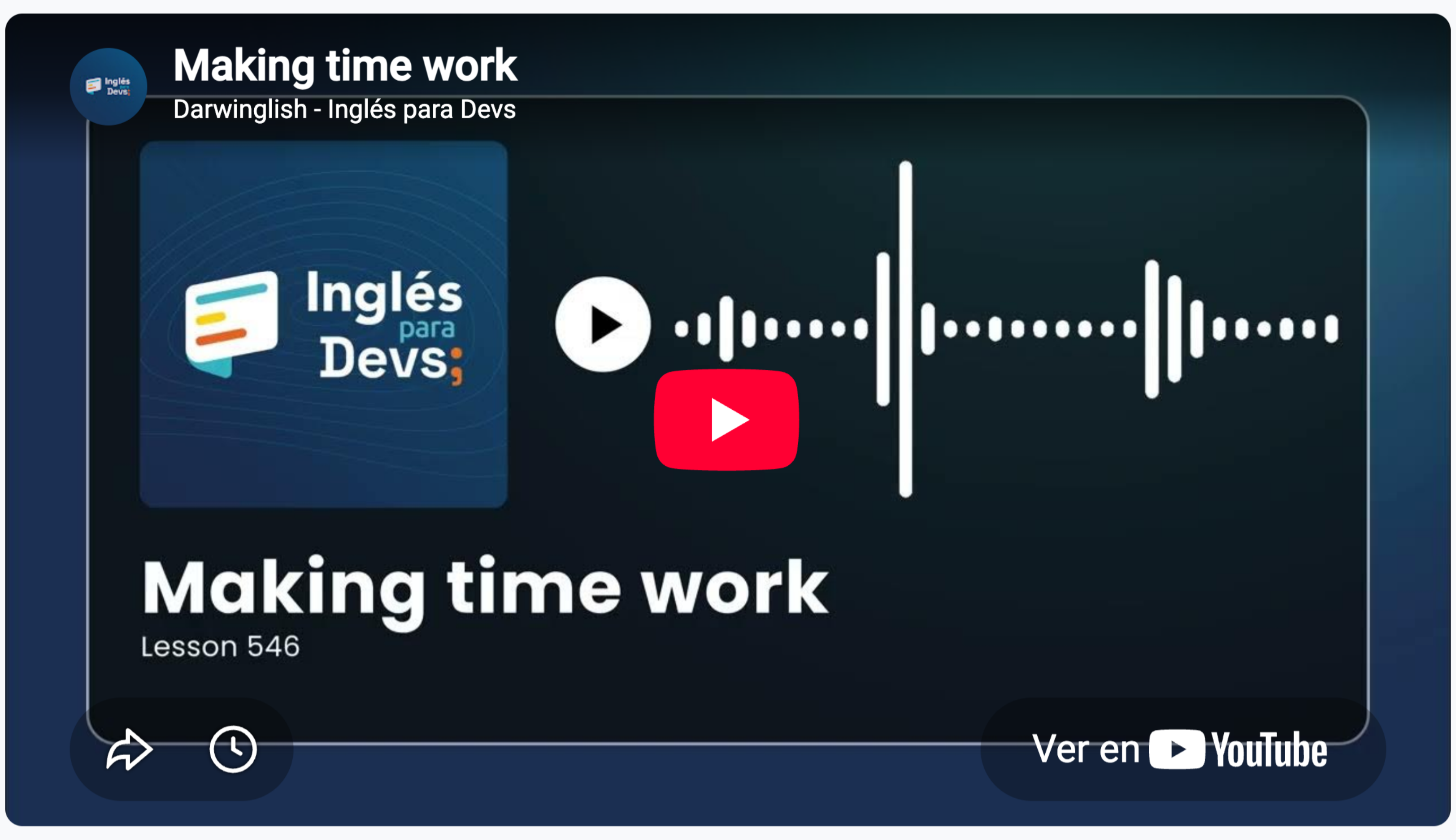
LEGACY

Making time work

Vocabulary in context

1 Listen carefully to the podcast. Choose one time management strategy and explain how it could help you at work.



Managing your time as a developer . . .

DEVHABITS.IO · PRODUCTIVITY

For many developers, the hardest part of the job isn't writing code — it's protecting the time to write it. Meeting overload, unclear priorities, and constant interruptions can make even experienced engineers feel unproductive. Here are some strategies that may help.

01

Time blocking is said to help many developers stay on track. By reserving specific hours for deep work, you can prevent interruptions from breaking your concentration.

02

Too many meetings may cause your **deep work sessions** to disappear from the calendar entirely. Some teams have found that **meeting-free mornings** enable engineers to do their best thinking before lunch.

03

A clear **task priority system** — like MoSCoW or a simple daily top-three list — is thought to help you decide what to work on next and stop decision fatigue from slowing you down.

04

Developers who use **async communication** report that it protects them from losing hours to Slack threads that could have been a two-line message.

05

Research suggests that a short **end-of-day shutdown ritual** — reviewing what got done and writing tomorrow's first task — may keep work anxiety from following you into your personal time.

06

Working in **focused sprints** with short breaks in between is believed to let your brain recover between tasks, which can make longer sessions feel less draining.

07

Building a realistic **weekly plan** every Monday is said to help engineers avoid taking on more work than they can actually deliver, which stops last-minute stress from piling up.

08

A **calendar buffer** — a 15-minute gap between meetings — may prevent your brain from going into the next call without having processed the previous one.

2 Look for the time management strategies in the article. Then complete the chart with what each strategy prevents or protects and its benefits.

Strategy	What it prevents or protects	The benefit
time blocking	*interruptions*	*helps you stay on track;* *protects deep work time*

Grammar — Describing causes and results

3 Figure it out. Write down the correct option in each question. Use the article to help you. Then read the grammar chart.

1.- What is time blocking said to help you ____________ ?(do/doing)

2.- What might too many meetings cause your deep work sessions ____________ (disappear/to disappear)

3.- What may an end-of-day ritual keep work anxiety ____________ (from following /following) you into your personal time?

Verb complements

VERB + OBJECT + VERB *help*, let, make* **Can also be used with an infinitive.*	*Time blocking is said to* **help** *you* **stay** *on track.* *Focused sprints can* **let** *your brain* **recover** *between tasks.*